

MechanicPro

Management System for a Mechanic Shop

Complete Guide to Installation, Daily Use, and Data Management

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Date June 2026
Document User Manual

Version 1.0.0
Status **Final**
Language English

Abstract

This document is the user manual for **MechanicPro**, a desktop application for managing the operations of a mechanic shop. It covers everything a user needs to install and run the application, navigate its interface, and perform all available tasks.

The manual is organised by workflow. Each chapter corresponds to a distinct area of the application: managing clients and vehicles, handling service orders, using the dashboard, and working with data import, export, and PDF generation.

No technical knowledge is required to follow this manual. For information about the system architecture or database design, refer to the Technical Report (TR-MECHPRO-001).

Keywords: MechanicPro, user manual, mechanic shop, service orders, clients, vehicles, CSV, PDF.

Revision History

This section outlines the revision history of the document.

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0.0	June 2026	Initial document created	Eduardo Freitas Fernandes

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1 Introduction

1.1 About This Manual

This manual is designed to guide you through the installation, setup, and daily use of MechanicPro. It provides step-by-step instructions for managing your shop's core operations, including clients, vehicles, and service orders.

The document is structured sequentially, starting from basic installation and interface navigation, progressing to core workflows like creating service orders, and finishing with data management tasks such as CSV exports and PDF generation.

This manual is intended for end-users: shop owners, managers, and mechanics. It covers the practical application of the software. It does *not* cover technical architecture, database design, or developer setup.

1.2 About MechanicPro

MechanicPro is a fast, secure, and easy-to-use desktop application specifically designed for mechanic shops. It replaces paper records and complicated spreadsheets with a streamlined digital system.

With MechanicPro, you can:

- Register clients and their vehicles.
- Track service orders, including parts, labor, and mileage.
- Monitor your shop's performance via an interactive dashboard.
- Print or download professional PDF invoices for your customers.
- Back up your data at any time via CSV export.

Note: MechanicPro runs entirely offline. All your data is stored securely on your local computer, ensuring complete privacy and fast access without requiring an internet connection.

1.3 Conventions Used in This Manual

Throughout this document the following conventions are used:

- **Bold navy text** refers to interface elements such as buttons, menu items, and field labels.
- `Ctrl+S` represents keyboard shortcuts.

- Steps to complete a task are numbered and shown like this:

1. This is how a step looks.
2. Each step describes one action.

Note: Blue boxes contain tips or additional context.

Warning: Yellow boxes highlight situations that may produce unexpected results.

Caution: Red boxes warn about irreversible actions, such as deleting records.

2 Installation

2.1 System Requirements

The hardware and software requirements to run the application are listed in Table 2.1.

Table 2.1: System Requirements

Component	Requirement
Operating System	Windows 10 or later / macOS 11 or later / Ubuntu 20.04 or later
RAM	4 GB minimum, 8 GB recommended
Disk Space	50 MB minimum (additional space required for database growth)
Additional	Windows: WebView2 runtime (included in Windows 11)

2.2 Installing the Application

2.2.1 Windows

1. Download the `MechanicPro_1.0.0_x64.msi` installer.
2. Double-click the installer file.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions.
4. Launch **MechanicPro** from the Start Menu or the desktop shortcut.

Note: Windows may show a security warning on first launch because the application is not signed with a commercial certificate. Click **More info** and then **Run anyway** to proceed.

2.2.2 macOS

1. Download the `MechanicPro_1.0.0_x64.dmg` file.
2. Open the `.dmg` and drag **MechanicPro** to your **Applications** folder.
3. On first launch, right-click the app and select **Open**.

2.2.3 Linux

1. Download the `.deb` or `.AppImage` package.
2. Install with `sudo dpkg -i MechanicPro_1.0.0_amd64.deb` or make the AppImage executable and run it directly.

2.3 First Launch

When you open MechanicPro for the very first time, the application will automatically set up your secure, local database file. This process is instant and requires no configuration on your part.

Because the database is new, your **Dashboard** will be empty, showing zero clients, vehicles, and service orders. You are now ready to begin adding your shop's data.

Note: MechanicPro stores all data locally on your machine. No account or internet connection is required.

3 Interface Overview

3.1 Main Window

The MechanicPro window is divided into two primary areas: the **Sidebar** on the left, which contains the main navigation menu, and the **Main Content Area** on the right, which displays the currently selected view (see Figure 3.1).

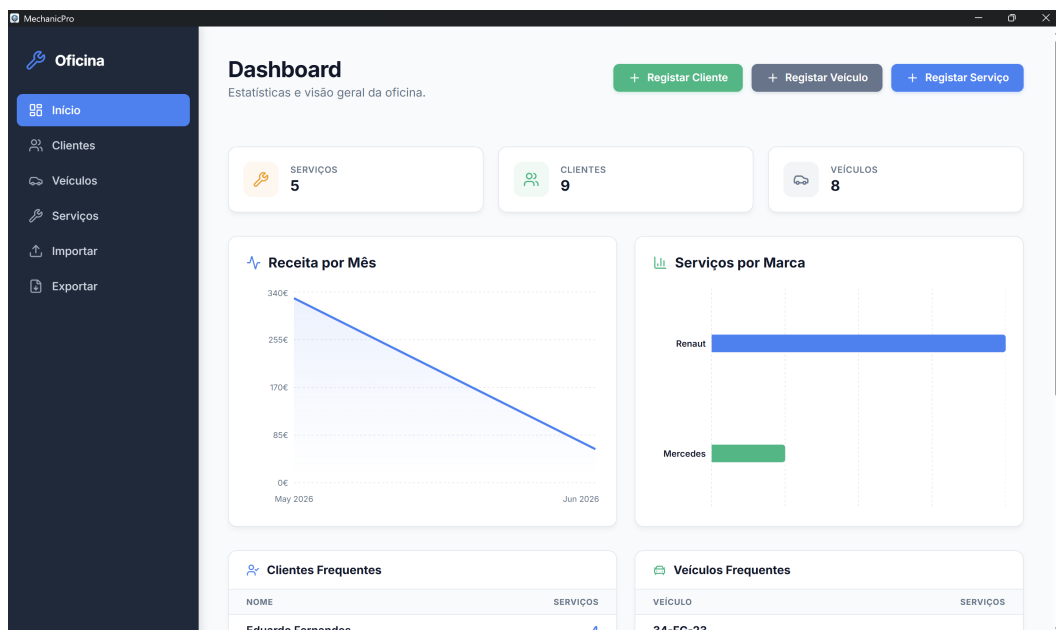


Figure 3.1: Main Page

3.2 Navigation

You can move between different sections of the application using the links in the left sidebar. Your current search filters and sorting preferences are remembered as you navigate between pages.

The main sections are:

- **Dashboard:** Summary statistics and shop performance charts.
- **Clients:** Manage the vehicle owners in your system.
- **Vehicles:** Manage the cars registered to your clients.
- **Service Orders:** Create, edit, and track repair and maintenance jobs.
- **Import / Export:** Backup and migrate your data using CSV files.

3.3 Dashboard

When you launch the application, you will land on the Dashboard. This screen provides a high-level overview of your shop's operations, showing the total number of clients, active vehicles, and the status of recent service orders (see Figure 3.2).

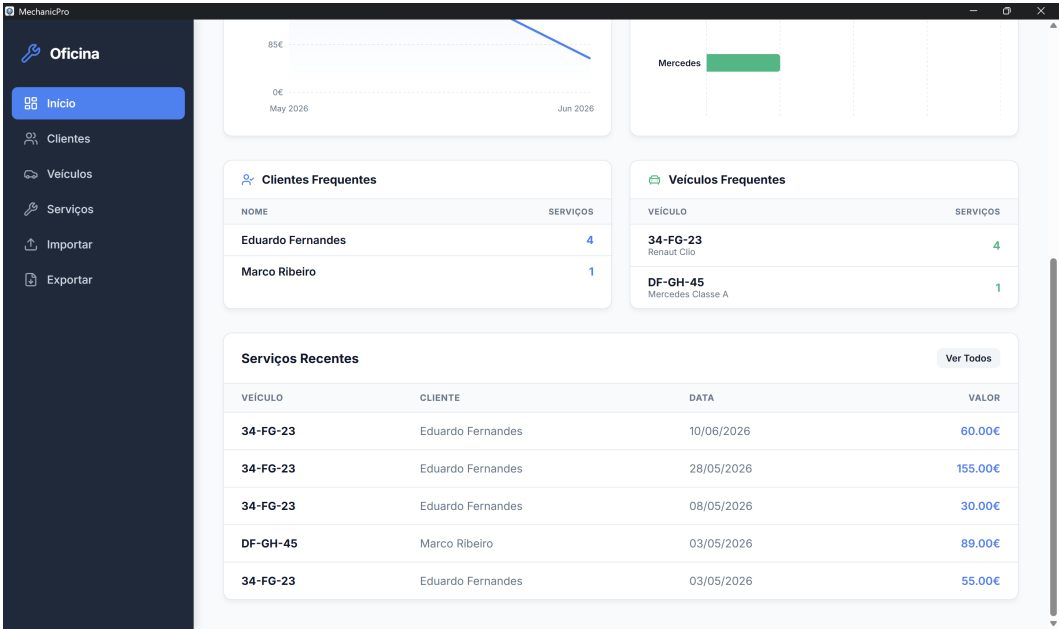
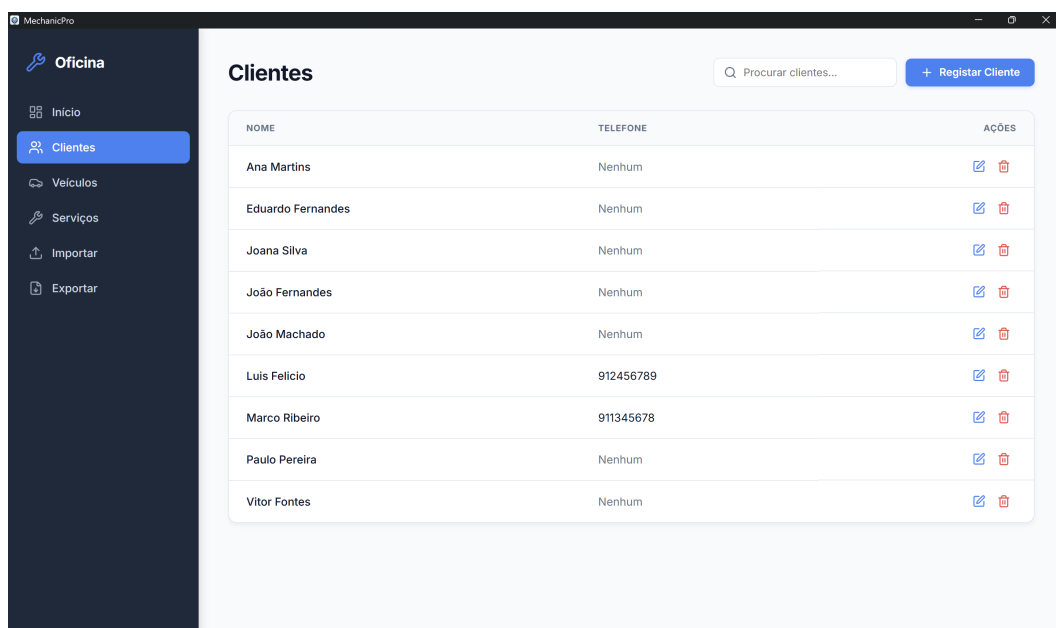


Figure 3.2: Dashboard Page

4 Managing Clients

4.1 Viewing the Client List

To view your clients, click on **Clients** in the sidebar. This opens a table displaying all registered vehicle owners. You can use the search bar at the top to quickly find a client by their name or phone number (see Figure 4.1).



NOME	TELEFONE	AÇÕES
Ana Martins	Nenhum	✎ ✖
Eduardo Fernandes	Nenhum	✎ ✖
Joana Silva	Nenhum	✎ ✖
João Fernandes	Nenhum	✎ ✖
João Machado	Nenhum	✎ ✖
Luis Felicio	912456789	✎ ✖
Marco Ribeiro	911345678	✎ ✖
Paulo Pereira	Nenhum	✎ ✖
Vitor Fontes	Nenhum	✎ ✖

Figure 4.1: Clients listing page

4.2 Adding a Client

1. Navigate to the **Clients** section.
2. Click the **New Client** button.
3. In the modal that appears, fill in the fields:
 - **Name:** full name of the client (required). Note that you cannot have two active clients with the exact same name.
 - **Phone:** contact phone number (optional).
4. Click **Save**. The list will automatically update to show the new client.

4.3 Editing or Deleting a Client

1. Locate the client in the list using the search bar.
2. Click the **Edit** icon next to their name.
3. Update their Name or Phone number as needed, and click **Save**.
4. To remove the client, click the **Delete** button.

Caution: Deleting a client does not permanently erase them from the database, but it hides them from all active lists. You can re-use their name for a new client later.

You can also view the history of a client, as shown in Figure 4.2.

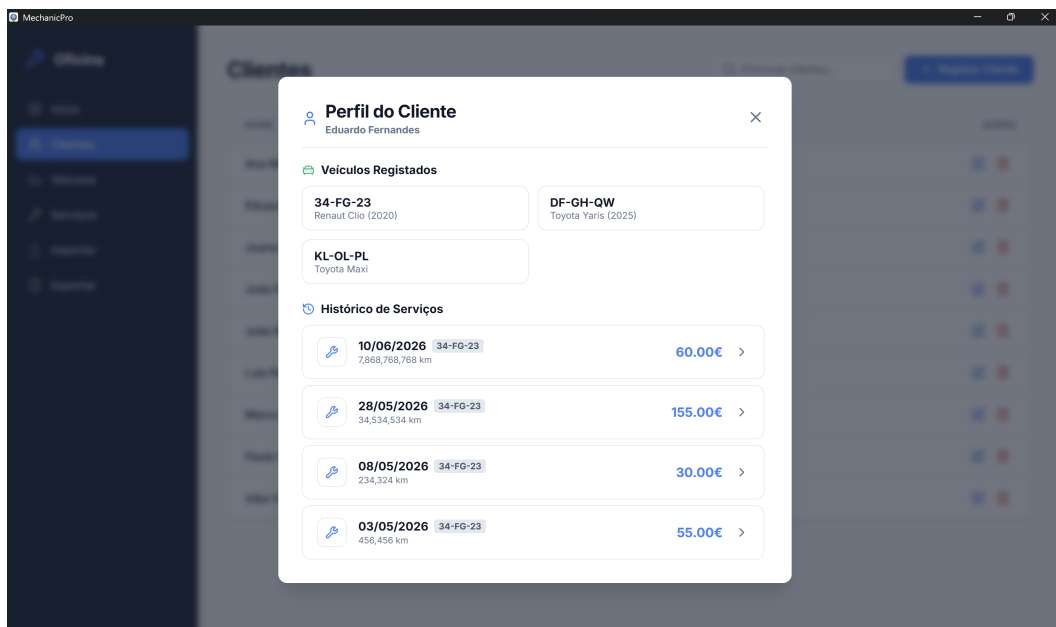
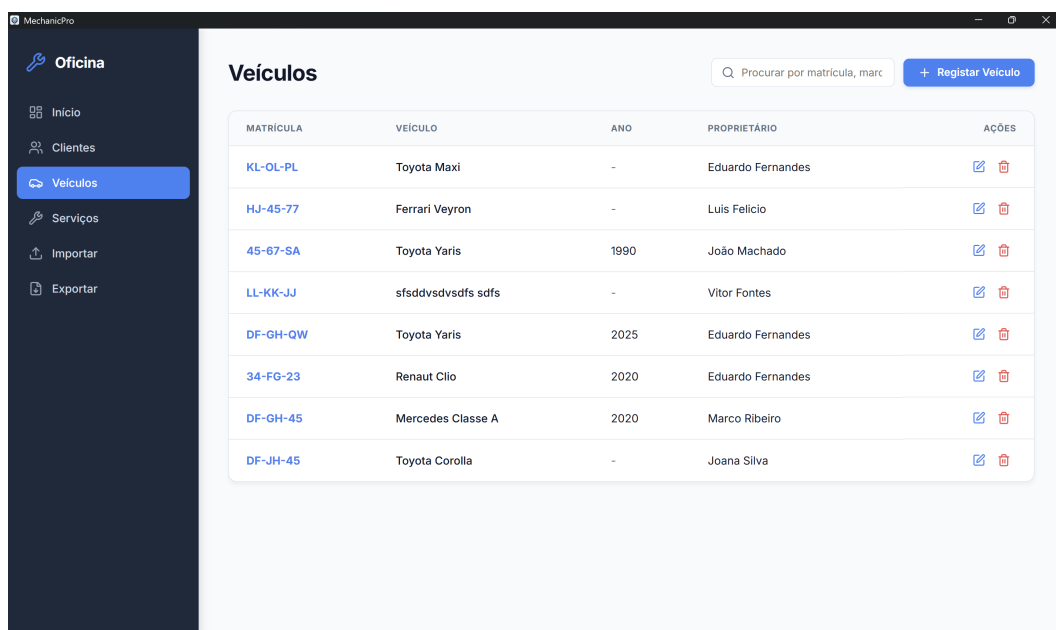


Figure 4.2: Client history overlay

5 Managing Vehicles

5.1 Viewing the Vehicle List

Click **Vehicles** in the sidebar to access the complete list of cars registered in the system. Each vehicle is inextricably linked to a specific client. You can use the search bar to locate a vehicle by its Licence Plate or Make (see Figure 5.1).



MATRÍCULA	VEÍCULO	ANO	PROPRIETÁRIO	AÇÕES
KL-OL-PL	Toyota Maxi	-	Eduardo Fernandes	✎ ✖
HJ-45-77	Ferrari Veyron	-	Luis Felicio	✎ ✖
45-67-SA	Toyota Yaris	1990	João Machado	✎ ✖
LL-KK-JJ	sfsddsvdsdfs sdf	-	Vitor Fontes	✎ ✖
DF-GH-QW	Toyota Yaris	2025	Eduardo Fernandes	✎ ✖
34-FG-23	Renaut Clio	2020	Eduardo Fernandes	✎ ✖
DF-GH-45	Mercedes Classe A	2020	Marco Ribeiro	✎ ✖
DF-JH-45	Toyota Corolla	-	Joana Silva	✎ ✖

Figure 5.1: Vehicles listing page

5.2 Adding a Vehicle

1. Navigate to the **Vehicles** section.
2. Click **New Vehicle**.
3. Fill in the required fields:
 - **Licence Plate**: unique identifier for the vehicle (required).
 - **Make**: manufacturer name.
 - **Model**: vehicle model.
 - **Year**: year of manufacture.
 - **Owner**: select the associated client.
4. Click **Save**.

5.3 Editing or Deleting a Vehicle

1. Locate the vehicle in the list using the search bar.
2. Click the **Edit** icon next to its plate.
3. Update the fields as needed, and click **Save**.
4. To remove the vehicle, click the **Delete** button.

Caution: Deleting a vehicle hides it from active lists, but its historical service records are preserved for auditing purposes.

You can review the historical records for any vehicle (see Figure 5.2).

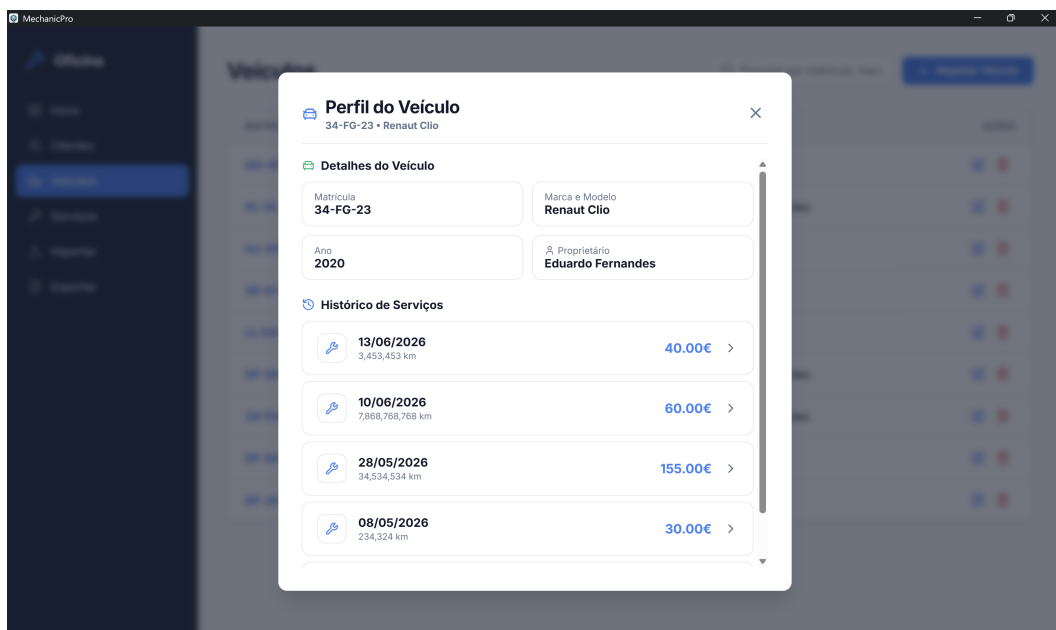


Figure 5.2: Vehicle history overlay

6 Service Orders

6.1 Overview

A Service Order is the core document in MechanicPro. It records a specific job performed on a vehicle. It includes the vehicle's mileage, itemized operations (parts or tasks), total labor hours, your hourly rate, and the final calculated price.

6.2 Creating a Service Order

1. Navigate to **Service Orders**.
2. Click **New Order**.
3. Select the **Client** and their associated **Vehicle**.
4. Record the current **Mileage** of the vehicle.
5. Add any general notes in the **Observations** field.
6. Add individual **Operations** (such as parts or specific tasks), giving each a description and a price.
7. Enter the total labor **Hours** and your **Hourly Rate**. The total price will calculate automatically based on the operations and labor.
8. Click **Save**.

Figure 6.1 illustrates the creation of a new service order.

Nova Ordem de Serviço Guardar Ordem

Informações Gerais

Cliente + Criar Novo Veículo

Selecionar Cliente Selecionar Veículo

Data Quilometragem (km) Mão de Obra (Horas) Preço Hora (€)

06/13/2026 1 20

Operações e Peças Preencha a descrição e o preço para cada item. + Adicionar Linha

#	DESCRIÇÃO	PREÇO (€)
1	Descrição da operação...	0.00
2	Descrição da operação...	0.00
3	Descrição da operação...	0.00
4	Descrição da operação...	0.00

Figure 6.1: Creating a new Service Order

6.3 Sorting Service Orders

By default, service orders are listed chronologically. You can click the column headers in the Service Orders table to change the sorting (for example, sorting by Date in descending order to see the newest jobs first, or by Total Price to see the most expensive jobs).

6.4 Viewing Service History

To see a history of all past service orders, you can view the main Service Orders list. Alternatively, viewing a specific Vehicle's profile will show a timeline of all service orders associated with that specific car (see Figure 6.2).

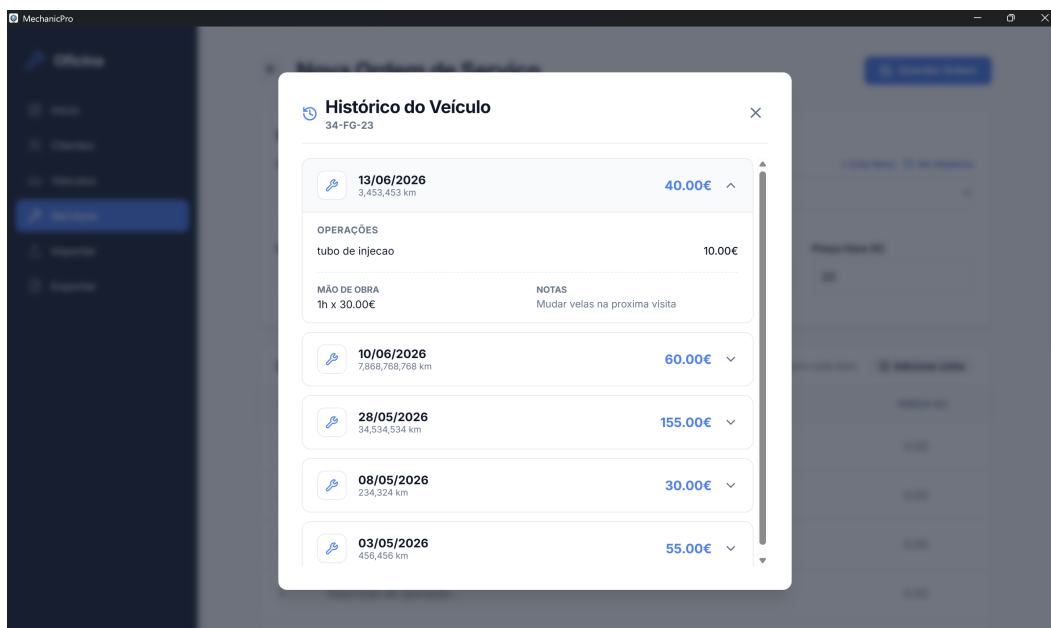


Figure 6.2: Service History View

6.5 Downloading Service Details

Once a service order is finalized, you can generate a professional PDF invoice to print or email to your customer. Simply open the service order details and click the **Download PDF** button. See Chapter 8 for more information on PDF generation.

7 Dashboard

7.1 Overview

The Dashboard provides an immediate snapshot of your shop's health and workload. It is designed to be a quick reference point rather than a detailed management screen (see Figure 7.1).

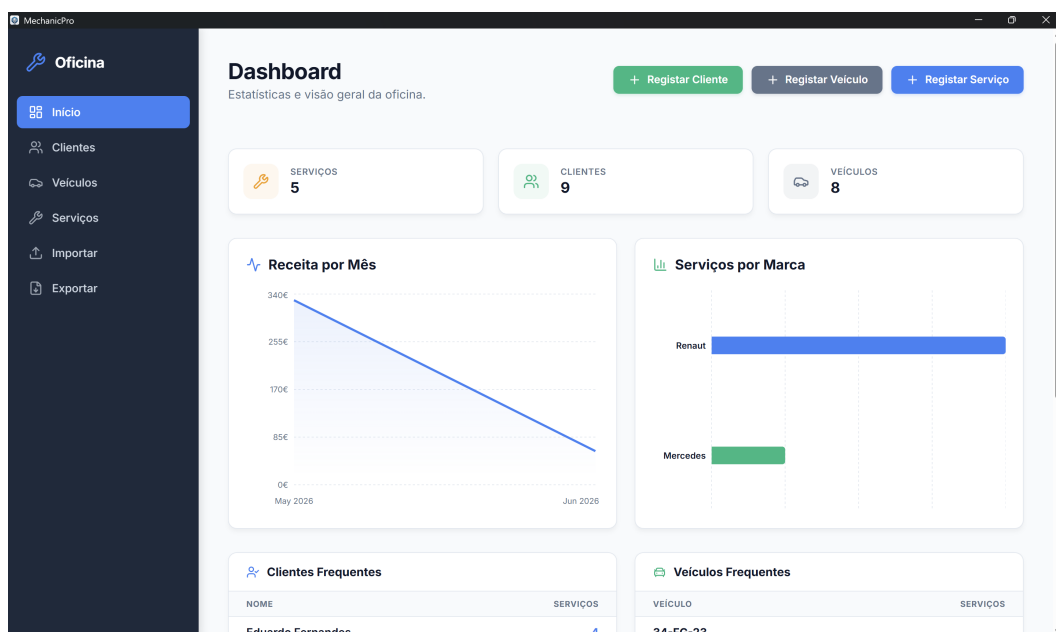


Figure 7.1: Dashboard Overview

7.2 Statistics and Top Lists

At the top of the dashboard, you will see key performance indicators:

- **Serviços** (Total Services): The total number of service orders recorded.
- **Clientes** (Total Clients): The number of active clients.
- **Veículos** (Total Vehicles): The number of active vehicles.

Below the key metrics, you will find quick-reference lists for your **Frequent Clients** and **Frequent Vehicles**, ranking those with the most recorded services, as well as a list of **Recent Services** for quick access.

7.3 Charts

The dashboard also includes interactive charts to visualize your shop's trends:

- **Revenue by Month:** An area chart showing the total value of services performed each month.
- **Services by Brand:** A bar chart showing the breakdown of vehicles serviced by their manufacturer.

You can hover over the data points in these charts to see exact numbers.

8 Data Management

8.1 Exporting Data to CSV

MechanicPro allows you to export your data (Clients, Vehicles, and Service Orders) at any time to standard CSV files, which can be opened in Excel or Google Sheets.

1. Navigate to the **Import / Export** section in the sidebar.
2. Under the Export tab, select the type of data you wish to export.
3. Click **Export CSV**.
4. Choose a location on your computer to save the file.

8.2 Importing Data from CSV

You can bulk-import clients and vehicles from existing spreadsheets to save time during initial setup.

Warning: Importing a CSV file will add records to the existing data. It does not replace or delete current records.

8.2.1 Required CSV Format

The import file must use UTF-8 encoding. The columns must exactly match the system's requirements:

Clients CSV

The expected structure for the clients CSV file is detailed in Table 8.1.

Table 8.1: Required CSV Format: Clients

Column	Required	Notes
name	Yes	Full name of the client
phone	No	Contact number

Vehicles CSV

The expected structure for the vehicles CSV file is detailed in Table 8.2.

Table 8.2: Required CSV Format: Vehicles

Column	Required	Notes
plate	Yes	Unique Licence Plate
brand	Yes	Manufacturer (Make)
model	Yes	Vehicle model
year	No	Manufacturing year

1. Navigate to the **Import / Export** section.
2. Select the type of data you are importing.
3. Click **Choose File** and select your CSV file.
4. Review the preview to ensure the columns align correctly.
5. Click **Import**.

Caution: Records created by import cannot be automatically undone. Make an export backup before importing new data.

8.3 Generating PDF Documents

MechanicPro includes a built-in PDF generator for creating professional invoices and service summaries.

1. Open a finalized service order from the **Service Orders** list.
2. Review the total cost, mileage, and itemized lists to ensure accuracy.
3. Click the **Download PDF** button.
4. The PDF will be saved to your computer, ready to be printed or emailed to the client.

9 Troubleshooting

9.1 Common Issues

Table 9.1 lists some common issues and their solutions.

Table 9.1: Common Troubleshooting Issues

Problem	Solution
Application does not open	Check that WebView2 is installed (Windows only). Try reinstalling the application.
CSV import fails	Verify the file is UTF-8 encoded and that all required columns are present with the correct header names.
Data appears missing after reinstall	The database is stored separately from the application. See Section 9.2 for the file location.
PDF does not download	Check that you have write permission to the chosen folder.

9.2 Data File Location

If you need to manually back up your database file, or if you are moving MechanicPro to a new computer, you can find the SQLite database file at the following standard locations depending on your operating system:

- **Windows:** %APPDATA%\MechanicPro\mechanicpro.db
- **macOS:** ~/Library/Application Support/MechanicPro/mechanicpro.db
- **Linux:** ~/.local/share/MechanicPro/mechanicpro.db

Note: You can back up your data by simply copying this `mechanicpro.db` file to a safe location (such as a USB drive or cloud folder) while the application is closed.

A Glossary

Table A.1 defines key terms used throughout this manual.

Table A.1: Glossary of Terms	
Term	Definition
Client	A person or entity whose vehicle is serviced.
Vehicle	A car or other vehicle registered under a client.
Service Order	A record of a service performed or requested.
CSV	Comma-Separated Values. A plain text file format for tabular data.
PDF	Portable Document Format. A fixed-layout document format used for service records.

B Keyboard Shortcuts

There are currently no custom global keyboard shortcuts. Standard operating system shortcuts for copying (`Ctrl+C`) and pasting (`Ctrl+V`) apply within all text fields.